

An Introductory meeting within the project „Build knowledge - protect yourself“ 16.02.2021.

The Safety at work Association of Montenegro had organized an introductory meeting within the project „Build knowledge - protect yourself“, which is funded by the Ministry of Economic Development (formerly the Ministry of Labor and Social Welfare) on February 16, 2021. year, at the Hotel Terminus in Podgorica. During the meeting, which they got acquainted with the planned activities, was attended by representatives of employers, employees, public institutions, experts for safety and health at work and the media.



Construction site is one of the largest, but also the most risky industries on a global level for the life and health of employees. Employees in the construction sector are exposed to a high risk of injuries at work, especially severe and fatal, which is of great concern to the International Labor Organization, the European Agency for Safety and Health at work - EU OSHA, but also public and private institutions in Montenegro and employee representatives. and occupational health and safety experts, given that one of the criteria for closing Chapter 19 is the implementation of the

Law on Occupational Safety and Health, which has been harmonized with the relevant EU Directives, with special emphasis on the field of construction.



Through the planned workshops and trainings, preparation of flyers for employees on construction sites, guidelines and instructions for the work of labor inspectors in the field of occupational safety and health, training of coordinators on construction sites (K1 and K2) by international experts from the ILO -a, awareness raising campaigns, calls for awards in the field of HSW, a conference to be organized to mark the World Day for Safety and Health at Work - April 28, a tour of construction sites to train employees, as well as numerous panel discussions for professionals, coordinators and public institutions, through which the SWAM will strive to contribute to raising the awareness of employers and employees, when it comes to safety and health at work on construction sites.

The general goal of this project is to solve the identified problems, in order to reduce the number of injuries at work in the construction sector - severe, collective and fatal, as well as occupational and work-related diseases. This will be achieved by:

- Improving the capacity of managers and strengthening the quality of work and the role of professionals who have obligations, but also responsibilities in the implementation of protection measures in the field of occupational safety and health in the construction sector, through a panel discussion that will be organized. At the panel discussion, they will gain practical knowledge that will help them more easily identify specific problems faced by employees of different professional qualifications and specialties for certain jobs on temporary and mobile construction sites, and will be able to take more effective preventive measures through the implementation of the Law on protection and health at work in the field of construction, which is one of the criteria for closing Chapter 19, which will lead to a reduction in the number of injuries;



- Improving the work of labor inspectors in the field of occupational health and safety, which are the main regulatory instrument for the implementation of the Law on Occupational Safety and Health. In addition to the lack of equipment, another problem of labor inspection is that it has a limited number of inspectors with technical - expert knowledge required for site inspection. For this reason, it is necessary to strengthen the technical capacity of labor inspectors in the field of occupational health and safety, in order to provide integrated services and more supervision with existing available resources. Given the high number of injuries at work in construction, it is planned to conduct training on site inspection for labor inspectors for the area of safety and health at work, especially with a focus on small and micro construction sites, and the training will be performed by experts from the region and

Europe, from the ILO. The aim of these lectures will be to acquaint labor inspectors in the field of occupational safety and health with the necessary skills to conduct effective inspection control of working conditions and occupational health and safety in construction. Through these trainings, they will gain practical knowledge and learn ways to develop a methodology for conducting inspections of construction works from the planning stage to the submission of the inspection report. After that, a call will be issued for the engagement of experts in this field, which will prepare a Guide for labor inspectors in the field of HSW, which will be published, and which will serve as guidelines for inspectors to enable proactive visits since inspection visits play a crucial role in prevention of construction site accidents and health problems, as set out in the 1988 ILO Convention on Safety and Health in Construction, No.167 in Article 35 (b);



- Strengthening the capacity of employees, since there is a great unmet need to improve the capacity in the field of health and safety at work, both for employers and employees, in order to more effectively apply the measures of the Law on Public Health. This will be achieved through training, by hiring competent experts in this field. Emphasis will be placed on the education of employees with a low level of education, who are most often injured, through practical training on the spot, on the construction site, where a team composed of experts in the field of SHW will acquaint them with their rights, obligations and responsibilities. (For example: through these on-site practical trainings, they will be introduced to the most common hazards on the construction site when performing common work, such as, among other things, work at height, since falls account for a high percentage of accidents on construction sites and their very nature). a large number of these accidents result in serious and

even fatal injuries. Accordingly, all employees and their work organizers will receive information and training on risk perception and safe work practices from the aspect of work at height, as well as the importance of using personal protective equipment as a protective measure. in order to prevent exposure to hazards, all in accordance with the Ordinance on measures for protection and health at work on temporary and mobile construction sites). In addition, 1,500 flyers will be prepared and printed, containing basic, pictorial information on the greatest risks of injury on the construction site, which will be distributed to employees in the construction sector;

- Strengthening the capacity of future coordinators for safety and health at work in the project development phase, as well as during the execution of works, since it is crucial that coordinators are better trained to find the best possible solutions in the field of construction technologies and occupational safety and health. . To this end, one of the project activities will be to organize a conference / expert visit of eminent experts from the region (Serbia, Slovenia) who will share their experiences in the field of coordinators, give possible suggestions and guidelines and point out possible problems and challenges. had during the introduction of these practices in their countries and give advice on how to solve them in the most efficient way. In this way, it will contribute to better implementation of the Law on Occupational Safety and Health in the field of construction, which is one of the measures to close Chapter 19, and in that way there will be a reduction of injuries, especially severe and fatal ones.
- Through the campaign to promote safety and health at work, within which a call for awards will be issued to individuals and legal entities who have made the greatest contribution in this area in the construction sector and marking the World Day for Safety and Health at Work in this way, attention was drawn to some good practices, which will be an incentive and example to others, when it comes to fulfilling the legal obligations and responsibilities of employers provided by the Law on Occupational Safety and Health.



The implementation of these goals will achieve the public interest by reducing economic losses due to injuries at work, occupational diseases and work-related illnesses (sick leave, early and disability pensions), and through the exchange and promotion of good practice and affirmation of socially responsible companies will draw attention. to some good practices, and employers who invest in the protection and health of their employees, who are in fact the most important capital of any company, will be an incentive and example to others, which will contribute to raising the collective level of awareness.

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